

The International HPC Summer School

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What is the IHPCSS?

- The International High Performance Computing Summer School is an in-person, one-week, intensive training event held in June or July in different locations in the world since 2010.
- International partners like XSEDE (US), PRACE (EU) and RIKEN (Japan) select students with the potential to use and advance HPC in their respective fields.
- They pay for those students to attend, and also provide and fund instructors and staff.
- The event contains a unique mentoring component to help students navigate their careers in HPC.
- Compute Canada was a partner from 2014 until 2017, and SciNet from 2018 till 2023, and the Alliance from 2025 onwards.



Alliance Pilot Project

Tania?



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NTCC IHPCSS Working Group

- Being a partner involves:
 - attending the international organization committee meetings
 - being part of the program development
 - running the selection process for Canadian applications
 - inviting selected students, and
 - supporting them at the event.
- The Alliance delegated these to the National Training Coordination Council (NTCC).
- The Alliance requires a proposal for the event's funding, which the WG wrote. (It helps that the Alliance Training Coordinator is part of the WG).
- Finance and conditions on expenses were, handled by the Alliance in 2025, by SciNet in 2026.
- The latter required another proposal from SciNet to the Alliance.



IHPCSS 2025: Lisbon, Portugal



<https://ss25.ihpcss.org>

- Canadian students applied: **137**
 - Canadian students selected: **10**
 - Returning mentor: **1**
 - Instructors sent:
Yohai Meiron, James Willis, and
Ramses van Zon (paid by SciNet)
 - IHPCSS Working group:
Sarah Huber, Moïra Dion, Ramses
van Zon, and Catherine Di Vita
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- Reviewers: Sarah Huber, Moïra Dion, Yohai Meiron, Alex Razoumov, James Willis, Sarah Cameron-Pesant, Bruno Mundim, Vladimir Slavnic, Marco Saldarriaga, Chris Want, Jerry Li, Matthew Smith, Paul Preney, Chris Loken, Jane Fry

IHPCSS 2026: Perth, Australia

<https://ss26.ihpcss.org>



- Canadian students applied: **232**
- Canadian students selected: **10**
- Returning mentor: **1**
- Instructors to be sent:
Sarah Huber, Alex Razoumov,
Ramses van Zon
- IHPCSS Working group:
Sarah Huber, Julie Faure-Lacroix,
Ramses van Zon, and Tania Tan
- Reviewers: Yohai Meiron, Alex Razoumov, James Willis, Bruno Mundim, Vladimir Slavnic, Marco Saldarriaga, Chris Want, Jerry Li, Matthew Smith, Gurpreet Matharoo, Chris Loken, Olivier Fisette, Ross Dickson, Patrick Mann



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Evolving content

- The main focus is and remains large scale HPC.
- The technical content is reviewed every year.
- The IHPCSS has changed significantly since the School was first run in 2010:
 - GPU programming has become a standard component.
 - The big data/machine learning/AI component is growing.
 - There's even a Python for HPC session.
 - But, on purpose, it will not become an AI conference.
 - The mentoring component is unique and well-established.
- Every year much effort is put into collecting feedback, understanding the skill landscape and adjusting the technical content.

Scott Callaghan et al. 2025. Fifteen Years of International HPC Summer School. In PEARC '25, ACM, New York, NY, USA, Article 17, 1–8. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3708035.3736011>



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Lessons Learned

- Budget needs fairly large margins to account for rising costs and unknown origins of participants.
- VISAs are always an uncertain issue; in 2025, two students could not make it because of delays in VISA appointments.
- The working group only needs to meet frequently in specific periods.
- We need more reviewers (or advertise less...).
- Coordinating the finances between two organizations is painful and slow; best try to avoid.

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- But it is worth it, there is a lot of demand.
 - Hoping for a multi-year training strategy that includes this event! (so we may bring it to Canada?)

